Turning 18: What Changes — Key Notes (Dec 11, 2026)

Keep this next to you during the webinar. Plain words, the key lines, and what to say when a question gets personal.

The one-page version

Turning-18 webinar: adult rules begin, the money change (parents' income counts differently), the age-18 SSI review, DAC on a parent's record, decisions at 18, school at 18, the five papers, January start steps.

Say it exactly this way

'A no at 15 can become a yes at 18 — ask the question fresh.' 'Before a parent files for retirement, ASK FIRST — the order of filings can protect Medicaid.' 'Papers are gold this year.'

The five papers (read slowly)

1) Teen's ID + Social Security card copies. 2) Letters from Social Security. 3) List of doctors, clinics and medicines. 4) School papers — current 504 plan. 5) Guardianship or court papers, if any.

Legal line — do not cross

Guardianship is a legal decision. We explain the questions and help families get ready; a Texas attorney makes the legal step. Never give legal advice.

If you get a hard question

Say: 'That one needs your family's private details — your teen's exact dates matter. Book your free first talk and we will map it together.' Then move on kindly.